1. Purpose

To provide information regarding opening Port 25 in Azure CSP subscriptions.

Subscriptions of all types created prior to November 15, 2017, may be able to send email over Port 25. All subscriptions created after may have Port 25 blocked.

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3. Reference

3.1. CSP Subscriptions

Outbound email messages that are sent directly to external domains (such as outlook.com and gmail.com) from a virtual machine (VM) are blocked from CSP subscriptions in Microsoft Azure.

Port 25 outbound communication is available on Azure App Service and Azure Functions through the virtual network integration feature, or when App Service Environment v3 is used. Port 25 outbound traffic can also be sent through Azure Firewall. The subscription-type restrictions below still apply. Sending email on Port 25 is unsupported for all other Azure Platform-as-a-Service (PaaS) resources.

3.1.1. Recommended Solution

You may use authenticated SMTP relay services to send email from Azure VMs or from Azure App Service. (These relay services typically connect through TCP port 587, but they support other ports.)

These services are used to maintain IP and domain reputation to minimize the possibility that external domains reject your messages or put them to the SPAM folder. Microsoft offers Azure Communication Services as an authenticated SMTP relay service; default rate limits can be raised via a support case. SendGrid is another third-party SMTP relay service, but there are others. You might also have an authenticated SMTP relay service on your on-premises servers. Use of authenticated SMTP relay services on port 587 is not restricted in Azure, regardless of subscription type.

3.2. Pay-As-You-Go Subscriptions

Outbound port 25 communication is blocked from all resources. No requests to remove the restriction can be made, because requests aren't granted. If you need to send email from your virtual machine, you have to use an SMTP relay service.

3.3. Enterprise Agreement & MCA-E Subscriptions

For VMs and Azure Firewall that are deployed in standard Enterprise Agreement or Microsoft Customer Agreement for enterprise (MCA-E) subscriptions, the outbound SMTP connections on TCP port 25 are not blocked. Note: there is no guarantee that external domains will accept the messages; rejection or filtering by recipient providers is not covered by Azure support.

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For Enterprise Dev/Test subscriptions, port 25 is blocked by default. It is possible to have this block removed. To request removal, open the Azure Virtual Network resource in the Azure portal, go to the "Cannot send email (SMTP-Port 25)" section of Diagnose and Solve, and run the diagnostic. Qualified Enterprise Dev/Test subscriptions are exempted automatically. After exemption, VMs must be stopped, deallocated, and restarted to pick up the new network policy. If the virtual network has a delegated subnet (for example, to an App Service Environment), add and then remove a new temporary subnet in the virtual network. The exemption applies only to the requested subscription and only to VM traffic routed directly to the internet.

3.4. MSDN / Azure Pass / Azure in Open, Education & Free Trial

Outbound port 25 communication is blocked from all resources. No requests to remove the restriction can be made, because requests aren't granted. If you need to send email from your virtual machine, you have to use an SMTP relay service.

3.5. SMTP AUTH Basic Authentication

For tenants created before December 2026, SMTP AUTH using Basic Authentication will be disabled by default. Administrators will retain the ability to re-enable it if required.

For tenants created after December 2026, SMTP AUTH using Basic Authentication will no longer be available. OAuth will be the only supported authentication method for SMTP AUTH.

Microsoft has announced that the final retirement date for SMTP AUTH Basic Authentication will be communicated during the second half of 2027.

Customers should begin planning and executing their migration from SMTP AUTH Basic Authentication to OAuth as soon as possible to avoid future service disruptions.

4. Associated Documents

- Troubleshoot outbound SMTP connectivity in Azure | Microsoft Learn
- Azure network security groups overview | Microsoft Learn
- How to set up a multifunction device or application to send email using Microsoft 365 or Office 365 | Microsoft Learn
- Deprecation of Basic authentication in Exchange Online | Microsoft Learn
- Authenticate an IMAP, POP or SMTP connection using OAuth

5. Document Approval

This document has been approved by:

- Manager, Cloud Sales Engineering

6. Document Revision History

Number	***Effective Date***	***Revision History***	***Author***
1.0	10/23/23	Initial Version	David Bloom
2.0	5/13/26	Updated to reflect current Microsoft guidance: added MCA-E subscriptions, Azure Communication	David Tulley

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		Services, PaaS exceptions (App Service/Functions, ASE v3, Azure Firewall), and Dev/Test unblock procedure. Refreshed Microsoft Learn URL.	
2.1	10/8/26	Added Basic Auth Retirement	David Bloom

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